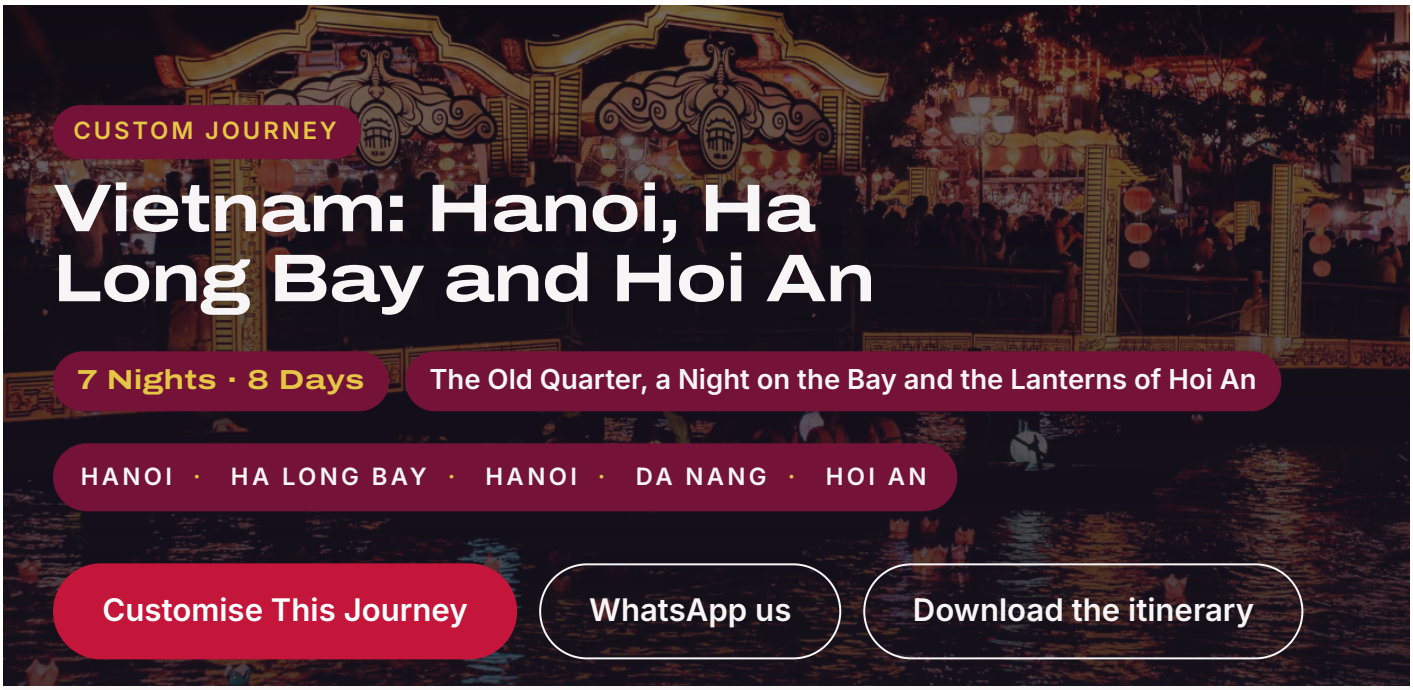
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CUSTOM JOURNEY

Vietnam: Hanoi, Ha Long Bay and Hoi An

7 Nights · 8 Days The Old Quarter, a Night on the Bay and the Lanterns of Hoi An

HANOI · HA LONG BAY · HANOI · DA NANG · HOI AN

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DURATION
7 Nights · 8 Days

ROUTE
Hanoi → Da Nang

PACE
Moderate

BEST SEASON
October to April

IDEAL FOR
Couples, First-Timers, Families

Vietnam runs more than a thousand miles from north to south, and the useful first visit does not try to cover it. This eight-day journey takes the north and the centre: Hanoi's Old Quarter and its food, a night on the water among the limestone karsts of Ha Long Bay, and then a short flight to Da Nang for the beach and the lantern-lit old town of Hoi An. It leaves the south for another time.

It is built for first-time travellers: one internal flight, one night afloat, a street-food walk in place of a restaurant list, and a last day you choose between a mountaintop spectacle and a quiet cave. The visa is an e-visa, the currency is cash-friendly, and every transfer, cruise and guide is arranged.

Journey Highlights

- **Walk** Hanoi's Old Quarter, its lanes named for the guilds that traded in them (silk, silver, paper) and still humming with scooters and street stalls.
- **Eat** your way through the city on a street-food walk (bun cha, banh mi and the famous egg coffee) after the Ho Chi Minh Mausoleum and the Temple of Literature.
- **Sleep** on the water in Ha Long Bay, among nearly two thousand limestone karsts, rather than rushing it as a day trip.
- **Kayak** between the towering formations at water level, and climb Ti Top Island for the view over the whole bay.
- **Fly** south to Da Nang and the soft sand of My Khe Beach, ninety minutes from the north's mist and history.
- **Wander** Hoi An's UNESCO-listed old town as the lanterns come on at dusk, then take a boat on the Thu Bon River.
- **Choose** your last day: the Golden Bridge at Ba Na Hills, held aloft by giant stone hands, or the quieter pagodas and caves of the Marble Mountains.

Itinerary at a Glance

DAY	DESTINATION	SIGNATURE EXPERIENCE
Day 01	**Hanoi**	Arrival; Hoan Kiem Lake and the Old Quarter night market
Day 02	**Hanoi**	Mausoleum, Temple of Literature, a street-food walk
Day 03	**Ha Long Bay**	Board the cruise; kayaking and sunset on deck

DAY	DESTINATION	SIGNATURE EXPERIENCE
Day 04	**Ha Long Bay to Hanoi**	Ti Top Island viewpoint; return to Hanoi
Day 05	**Hanoi to Da Nang**	Fly south; My Khe Beach
Day 06	**Hoi An**	The Ancient Town and a lantern boat on the river
Day 07	**Da Nang**	Ba Na Hills or the Marble Mountains
Day 08	**Departure**	A free morning; fly out of Da Nang

Day by Day

Expand all

Day 01 Hanoi: The Old Quarter

Step into Hanoi's Old Quarter, where narrow lanes named after the guilds that once traded there (silk, silver, paper) hum with scooters, street stalls and centuries of history layered into every corner. An evening stroll around Hoan Kiem Lake, followed by the buzz of the Old Quarter's night market.

Overnight in Hanoi

Day 02 Hanoi: A Layered City

A relaxed day tracing Hanoi's layered past, from wartime history to everyday street life: the Ho Chi Minh Mausoleum complex and the serene, centuries-old Temple of Literature in the morning, and in the afternoon a street-food walking tour through the Old Quarter (bun cha, banh mi, and Hanoi's famous egg coffee).

Overnight in Hanoi

Day 03 Ha Long Bay: The Cruise Begins

Boat · Overnight cruise on Ha Long Bay

Cruise out into Ha Long Bay's otherworldly seascape of nearly two thousand limestone karsts rising from emerald water. It is a UNESCO World Heritage Site best experienced slowly, over an overnight stay rather than a rushed day trip. Kayak between the towering formations at water level, and watch the sunset from the deck over a fresh seafood dinner.

Overnight aboard the cruise

Day 04 Ha Long Bay to Hanoi: The View from Ti Top

Drive · Return transfer to Hanoi

A gentle morning on the water and the climb to the Ti Top Island viewpoint for a sweeping panorama of the bay, then the road back to Hanoi or, if the cruise schedule allows, straight on to the airport.

Overnight in Hanoi

Day 05 Da Nang: South to the Coast

Fly · Hanoi to Da Nang, about 90 minutes

A short direct flight south trades the north's mist and history for central Vietnam's beaches and golden-lit old towns. Check in and unwind on the soft sand of My Khe Beach.

Overnight in Da Nang

Day 06 Hoi An: Lanterns at Dusk

Boat · Lantern-lit boat ride on the Thu Bon River

Hoi An's UNESCO-listed old town is a living museum of merchant houses, temples and canals, best explored on foot. Wander the Ancient Town (the Japanese Covered Bridge and the tailor shops that have dressed visitors for generations), and as the lanterns begin to glow at dusk, take a boat along the Thu Bon River.

Overnight in Hoi An

Day 07 Da Nang: A Mountain or a Cave

Choose your pace for the day: Ba Na Hills and its Golden Bridge, held aloft by two giant stone hands above the forest (a dramatic mountaintop spectacle), or the quieter Marble Mountains, with their hidden pagodas and caves.

Overnight in Hoi An

Day 08 Da Nang: Departure

A free morning for a last swim, a coffee or a little shopping before the transfer to Da Nang airport for your flight out.

Departure

Practical notes

Visa

Vietnam offers an e-visa to Indian passport holders. Apply online in advance, and allow a few working days. Check current rules with us when booking, as they change.

Flights

Hanoi to Da Nang direct is about ninety minutes, and easier than connecting through Ho Chi Minh City. Arrive at Hanoi (HAN) and depart from Da Nang (DAD).

Best time to visit

October to April. Hanoi's winter is damp in February and March, and central Vietnam sees rain in October and November. Tell us your dates and we will weight the itinerary north or south.

Currency

Vietnamese Dong. Carry some cash for markets and street food; cards are accepted in hotels and larger restaurants.

Pace

Moderate: a balance of culture, relaxation and light activity, with one flight and one

night on the water.